

Electronics For You and electronicsforu.com emerge as winners

As expected, *Electronics For You* and *www.electronicsforu.com* have emerged way ahead of all other publications and websites for media consumption in the Indian electronics industry. These findings are based on a survey done by IMRB on behalf of ELCINA—India's leading electronics industry association. A group of 367 people comprising professionals, entrepreneurs, academicians, students, hobbyists, influencers and others participated in this survey.

Microsoft Accelerator, Wipro join hands

Information technology major Wipro has said that it will work with select startups in India that are associated with Microsoft Accelerator programme to help them scale their businesses and take them to customers globally. Wipro will also look at startups to identify innovative solutions and products that they can build in their offerings and help generate value for its customers.

Infosys invests in ideaForge

Infosys has made an investment from its Innovation Fund in ideaForge, an Indian startup focused on unmanned aerial vehicle (UAV) solutions. The startup's UAVs have been widely deployed by Indian Armed Forces for surveillance, crowd monitoring and rescue operations, and offer a compelling solution for commercial applications in verticals such as energy, utilities, telecom and agriculture.

Thirty eight new mobile handset units set up since September 2015

As many as 38 new mobile handset manufacturing units with a combined capacity of over 20 million units per month have been established in India since September 2015, which include the units of Micromax and Lava International. These units have generated jobs for 38,300 people, Department of Industrial Policy and Promotion has stated in its Make in India Electronics & IT Sector Achievement report.

Panasonic plans local manufacturing of air purifiers

Home appliances and consumer electronics company Panasonic India has plans to manufacture air purifiers in

India starting this year. Panasonic, which is currently the number three player in the air purifier category, is expecting ten times growth in next five years with a revenue of ₹ 1.5 billion by selling over 100,000 units by FY 2020-21. The Japanese firm has 15 manufacturing units in India.

Micromax plans big with Make in India

Micromax Informatics is planning to make smartphones on a completely knocked-down basis in India, by March 2017. Micromax co-founder, Vikas Jain, said that the firm was on the verge of importing its first set of such units. He added, the new facilities will either be set up at Telangana or Bhiwadi, Rajasthan.

USAID clears US\$ 75 million loan for Indian solar sector

RBL Bank and United States Agency for International Development (USAID) has recently announced a loan guarantee programme worth US\$ 75 million to support off-grid and rooftop solar power projects in India. The programme is also expected to cover energy-efficiency projects pursued by small- and medium-sized enterprises.

World's largest solar farm is now in Tamil Nadu

The southern state of Tamil Nadu has overtaken California, USA, and now has the largest solar farm in one location in the world. The enormous solar farm, spread across a vast 2500-acre site in Tamil Nadu, comprises 380,000 foundations, 2,500,000 solar modules, 27,000 metric tonnes of structure, 576 inverters, 154 transformers and 6000 kilometres of cables.

India solar power tariffs hit new low

Solar power tariffs have dropped to a new low in India, from ₹ 4.34 per unit. This is a third of the going rate a few years back, and was the bid for a project in Rajasthan. The latest quote is lower than the price of power from several thermal power plants built by private firms, and slightly higher than tariffs offered by others like NTPC's tariff for thermal plants.

Electronics firm, Elecom, exits India

Elecom Co., a Japanese manufacturer of peripheral products and accessories for personal computers and other digital equipment, has closed its Indian unit after less than four years in the country, because it failed to gain traction in the price-sensitive market. Elecom India had targeted a US\$ 3 million turnover in the first year of operations and US\$ 30 million by 2017.

The company's state-of-art LED streetlights with wattage ratings of 25W, 45W, 60W, 72W, 90W and 120W have been awarded BIS certification, and these will have the ISI marking henceforth.

BIS certification conforms to Indian Standard IS 10322 (Part 5/Sec 3): 2012, which means the functional performance, safety and photometry of the company's product line in this segment meet the top standards set by BIS.

Crompton ties up with UK firm Goovee for the IoT

Crompton Greaves Consumer Electricals has tied up with UK based Goovee to be the latter's launch partner in India. Goovee connects lighting manufacturers and their customers to the IoT. Under the agreement, Crompton will be able to use the British firm's new lighting ecosystem to provide additional functionality and value to customer lighting and IoT solutions.

With this partnership, Crompton plans to foray into the world of the IoT and connected lighting in a big way. The Goovee ecosystem provides sensing, control and communication components that integrate with an enterprise-scale Cloud platform.

This offers a service-driven, scalable framework that can be integrated into LED lighting installations, significantly increasing control, monitoring and data analysis while driving performance and efficiency.